Contact

www.linkedin.com/in/holt-james-ds (LinkedIn)

Top Skills

Algorithms
Data Collection
Hypertext Transfer Protocol (HTTP)

Languages

English

James Holt, Ph.D.

Data Scientist in Insurance | Earth Scientist | Python Programmer
Dallas-Fort Worth Metroplex

Summary

I am a data scientist with a passion for learning, exploring, and solving problems. I have over 2 years of industry experience, and more than 7 years as a professional scientist. I have published three papers and presented at several international conferences. I am always eager to learn new things and improve my existing skills in my spare time. I am fascinated by the advances in technology, data science, earth sciences, and the latest video games!

Data science captures many disciplines, and each individual has a unique 'origin' story, here's mine:

I completed my Ph.D. in earthquake seismology at the University of Liverpool, UK in October 2019. Shortly after, I got a postdoc position at the University of Utah, where I worked for two years. There, I solved problems related to earthquake magnitude estimation and published two papers on my findings. During that time, I also taught myself the skills needed to transition to data science. However, I already had a strong foundation in topics such as digital signal processing, time series analysis, physical modeling, statistical modeling, and simulations. These are essential skills for any seismologist (or geophysicist in general).

In October 2021, I joined Bayer as a contractor data scientist. There, I worked on refining and creating random forest regression models, a deploying model pipelines aimed at forecasting crop-seed yield, using proprietary historic growth, agronomic, and weather data. This was my first venture into data science from academia, so I was able to become familiar with industry practices, and quirks. I learned how to communicate updates to both technical/non-technical stakeholders. I also became familiar with the Agile system of project management, where I would occasionally engage in scrum master responsibilities.

In June 2022, I became a full-time data scientist at Coyote Logistics (A UPS Company), where I maintained and improved, a live API multi-model service that predicted auction costs for truck loads. I led our pricing team, and improved data science communication standards with internal business partners. Expanded the model service to cover Canadian truck lanes, which is expected to increase revenue by more than 20%. I prototyped / deployed an add-on linear pricing model that reduced pricing bias from -10% to 0% for a rare load class, which is expected to improve revenue by 20-30%. I mentored multiple associate data scientists on best practices for software development, experimental design, modeling, and data engineering/data processing techniques, using different technologies.

Experience

USAA
Data Scientist
February 2024 - Present (2 months)
Dallas-Fort Worth Metroplex

Coyote Logistics
Data Scientist
June 2022 - September 2023 (1 year 4 months)
Remote

Bayer
Data Scientist
October 2021 - June 2022 (9 months)
Remote

University of Utah
3 years 1 month

Postdoctoral Researcher at University of Utah Seismograph Stations
November 2019 - October 2021 (2 years)
Salt Lake City, Utah

Visiting Researcher
October 2018 - October 2019 (1 year 1 month)
Salt Lake City, Utah

I visited the University of Utah Seismograph Stations and completed two projects for my Ph.D. thesis. 1. calculating Mw for small-to-moderate sized events and 2. calibrating a new local magnitude scale for earthquakes in Yellowstone National Park, USA.

University of Liverpool
Ph.D. Candidate
October 2015 - November 2019 (4 years 2 months)
Liverpool, United Kingdom

University of Utah
Visiting Researcher
June 2018 - August 2018 (3 months)
Salt Lake City, Utah

I visited the University of Utah Seismograph Stations and completed a pilot study which involved calculating Mw for small-to-moderate sized earthquakes in Utah.

ETH Zürich
Visiting Researcher
January 2017 - March 2017 (3 months)
Zürich Area, Switzerland

I undertook a two month placement with Donat Faeh's seismic hazard group working on theoretical and empirical site response modelling.

University of Liverpool - Geomagnetic Laboratory
Research Assistant
June 2014 - September 2014 (4 months)
University of Liverpool

- Measured palaeointensity of the Lena River basalts from Siberia
- Used multiple scientific instruments to measure their magnetic properties
- Used excel and in house software to interpret geomagnetic data
- Gained experience in independent study/research
- Experience of setting my own work schedule to achieve long term goals
- Presented results weekly to my supervisor (Dr Andy Biggin)
- Completed a successful pilot study in three months

Education

University of Liverpool

Doctor of Philosophy - Ph.D., Geophysics and Seismology · (2016 - 2019)

University of Liverpool

MRes, Decision Making under Risk and Uncertainty · (2015 - 2016)

University of Liverpool

Bachelor's Degree, Geophysics · (2012 - 2015)